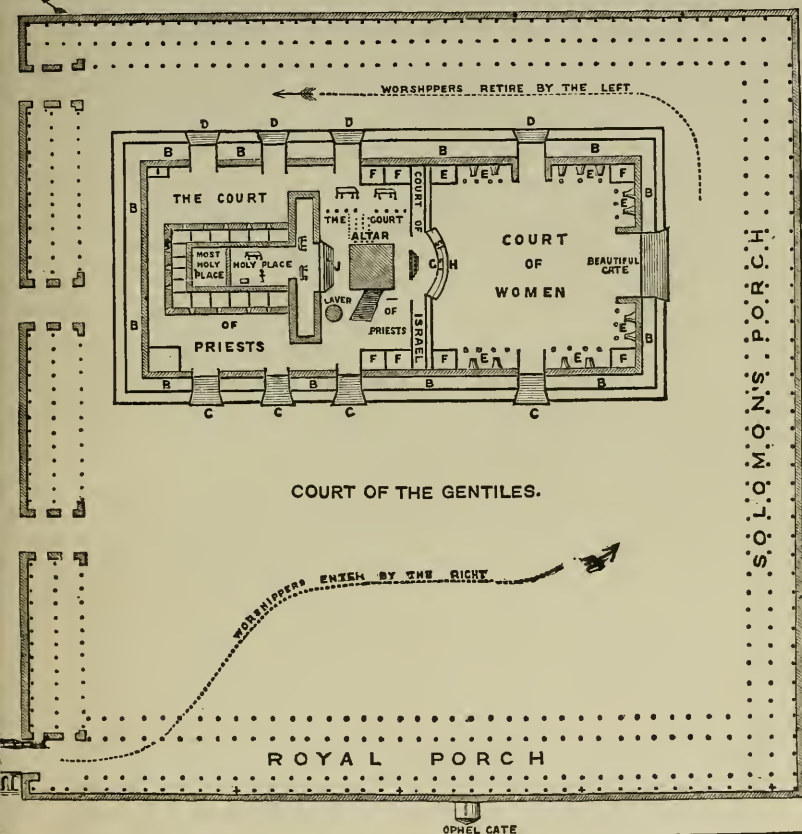


PLAN OF THE TEMPLE.

Tedi or
Tere (?)

M

TRANCE TO ANTONIA



COURT OF THE GENTILES.

- A. Royal Tyropoeon Bridge.
- B B. etc Terrace, or Chel, outside of which tradition places a low enclosure, called the Soreg.
- C C C. South Side Gates, the second on the right hand being the ancient Water Gate.
- D D D. North Side Gates.
- E E E E. Money Chests.
- F F. Courts and Chambers.

- G. Nicanor Gate.
- H. Fifteen Steps of the Levites.
- I. House of Stoves.
- J. Steps of the Priests.
- K. To Mount Zion.
- L. Shushan Gate, with arched roadway, to Mount of Olives (?)
- M. To Bezetha.

apartments for the Levites, and a synagogue. But, despite pharisaic punctiliousness, the noise, especially on the eve of the Passover, must have been most disturbing. For there the oxen, sheep, and doves selected as fit for sacrifices were sold as in a market; and here were those tables of the money-changers which the Lord overthrew when He drove from His Father's house them that bought and sold.¹ Within a short distance, in the court, a marble screen $4\frac{1}{2}$ feet high, and beautifully ornamented, bore Greek and Latin inscriptions, warning Gentiles not to proceed on pain of death. One of those very tablets, bearing almost the same words as those given by Josephus, has been discovered in late excavations. It was because they thought Paul had infringed this order, that the infuriated multitude "went about to kill him."² Beyond this enclosure a flight of fourteen steps, each 9 inches high, led up to a terrace 15 feet broad, called the "Chel," which bounded the *inner* wall of the Temple. We are now approaching the Sanctuary itself, which consisted, first, of three courts, each higher than the former, and, beyond them, of the Holy and Most Holy Places, with their outbuildings. Entering by the principal gate on the *east* we pass, first into the Court of the Women, thence into that of Israel, and from the latter into that of the Priests. This would have been, so to speak, the natural way of advancing. But there was a nearer road into the Court of the Priests. For both north and south, along the terrace, flights of steps led up to three gates (both north and south), which opened into the Court of the Priests, while a fourth gate (north and south) led into the middle of the Court of the Women. Thus there were nine gates opening from "the Terrace" into the Sanc-

¹ Matt. xxi. 12; John ii. 14. Compare also especially *Jer. Chag.* 78 a.

² Acts xxi. 31.

tuary—the principal one from the east, and four north and south, of which one (north and south) also led into the Court of the Women, and the other three (north and south) into that of the Priests.

These eight side gates, as we may call them, were all two-leaved, wide, high, with superstructures and chambers supported by two pillars, and covered with gold and silver plating. But far more magnificent than any of them was the ninth or *eastern* gate, which formed the principal entrance into the Temple. The ascent to it was from the terrace by twelve easy steps. The gate itself was made of dazzling Corinthian brass, most richly ornamented; and so massive were its double doors that it needed the united strength of twenty men to open and close them. This was the "Beautiful Gate;" and on its steps had they been wont these many years to lay the lame man, just as privileged beggars now lie at the entrance to continental cathedrals. No wonder that all Jerusalem knew him; and when on that sunny afternoon Peter and John joined the worshippers in the Court of the Women, not alone, but in company with the well-known cripple, who, after his healing, was "walking and leaping and praising God," universal "wonder and amazement" must have been aroused. Then, when the lame man, still "holding by" the apostles, again descended these steps, we can readily understand how all the people would crowd around in Solomon's Porch, close by, till the sermon of Peter—so fruitful in its spiritual results—was interrupted by the Temple police, and the sudden imprisonment of the apostles.

The Court of the Women obtained its name, not from its appropriation to the exclusive use of women, but because they were not allowed to proceed farther, except for sacri-

ficial purposes. Indeed, this was probably the common place for worship, the females occupying, according to Jewish tradition, only a raised gallery along three sides of the court. This court covered a space upwards of 200 feet square. All around ran a simple colonnade, and within it, against the wall, the thirteen chests, or "trumpets," for charitable contributions were placed.¹ These thirteen chests were narrow at the mouth and wide at the bottom, shaped like trumpets, whence their name. Their specific objects were carefully marked on them. Nine were for the receipt of what was legally due by worshippers; the other four for strictly voluntary gifts. Trumpets I. and II. were appropriated to the half-shekel Temple-tribute of the current and of the past year. Into Trumpet III. those women who had to bring turtledoves for a burnt and a sin-offering dropped their equivalent in money, which was daily taken out and a corresponding number of turtledoves offered. This not only saved the labour of so many separate sacrifices, but spared the modesty of those who might not wish to have the occasion or the circumstances of their offering to be publicly known. Into this trumpet Mary the mother of Jesus must have dropped the value of her offering² when the aged Simeon took the infant Saviour "in his arms and blessed God." Trumpet IV. similarly received the value of the offerings of young pigeons. In Trumpet V. contributions for the wood used in the Temple; in Trumpet VI. for the incense, and in Trumpet VII. for the golden vessels for the ministry were deposited. If a man had put aside a certain sum for a sin-offering, and any money was left over after its purchase, it was cast into Trumpet VIII. Simi-

¹ It was probably into one of these that the poor widow dropped her "two mites" (Luke xxi. 2).

² Luke ii. 22, 24.

iarly Trumpets IX., X., XI., XII., and XIII. were destined for what was left over from trespass-offerings, offerings of birds, the offering of the Nazarite, of the cleansed leper, and voluntary offerings. In all probability this space where the thirteen Trumpets were placed was the "treasury," where Jesus taught on that memorable Feast of Tabernacles.¹ We can also understand how, from the peculiar and known destination of each of these thirteen "trumpets," the Lord could distinguish the contributions of the rich who cast in "of their abundance" from that of the poor widow who of her "penury" had given "all the living" that she had.² But there was also a special treasury-chamber, into which at certain times they carried the contents of the thirteen chests; and, besides, what was called "a chamber of the silent," where devout persons secretly deposited money, afterwards secretly employed for educating children of the pious poor.

It is probably in ironical allusion to the form and name of these treasure-chests that the Lord, making use of the word "trumpet," describes the conduct of those who, in their almsgiving, sought glory from men as "sounding a trumpet" before them³—that is, carrying before them, as it were, in full display one of these trumpet-shaped alms-boxes (literally called in the Talmud, "trumpets"), and, as it were, sounding it.⁴

¹ John vii. viii., see specially viii. 20.

² Mark xii. 41; Luke xxi. 1.

³ Matt. vi. 2.

⁴ The allusion is all the more pointed when we bear in mind that each of these trumpets had a mark to tell its special object. It seems strange that this interpretation should not have occurred to any of the commentators, who have always found the allusion such a *crux interpretum*. An article in the *Bible Educator* has since substantially adopted this view, adding that trumpets were blown when the alms were collected. But for the latter statement there is no historical authority whatever, and it would contravene the religious spirit of the times.